

Choosing the Right Unit

Elaboration 1 · Picking a unit that suits the job

ELABORATION FOCUS

Choosing a suitable informal unit for the length of an object, and explaining why a long unit suits long things and a short unit suits short things.

LEARNING INTENTION I can pick the best unit and say why.

Long thing

Long unit

Short thing

Short unit

Say why

1

Look at the Object

Step 1: is the object long or short? Step 2: guess how big a unit would suit.

2

Pick and Test

Step 3: try the unit. Step 4: too many to count means go bigger.

3

Justify Your Choice

Step 5: say why the unit suits. Step 6: swap to a smaller unit if you need to be exact.

MODEL · WHICH UNIT SUITS THE JOB

A long room needs a long unit; a short crayon needs a short unit.

Match the unit to the size of the object

Room  12 steps

Crayon  6 cubes

Long unit for long things · short unit for short things

Steps suit a room; cubes would take hundreds. Cubes suit a crayon.

TEACHER MODELLING ROUTINE I do → We do → You do

WATCH FOR

Choosing a unit so big or so small that counting becomes hard or unfair.

REMEMBER

Say it to students as: "Big thing, big unit. Small thing, small unit."

MATERIALS

Footsteps, arm spans, string, straws, paper clips, cubes, pencils, hands.